

August Workout Calendar — Foundation Phase

Starts today, Wed July 29 → runs through Sun Aug 31 Split: 5x/week Push/Pull/Legs (PPL), full commercial gym **Training time:** ~8:10-9:40 AM (per your daily schedule) — adjust start time as needed, keep the ~90 min session length **Phase goal:** re-groove movement patterns, get connective tissue and CNS reacclimated after the 6-8 month layoff, and start progressive overload without wrecking yourself in week 1. This is the "muscle memory" window — expect fast strength returns if you don't rush the first two weeks.

How Load Progresses Across August

You're coming off a long layoff, so week 1 is deliberately lighter than what you'll be capable of by week 3-4. Rushing this risks joint/tendon issues since strength comes back faster than tissue tolerance does.

Week	Dates	Effort Level	Guidance
Week 1	Wed Jul 29 – Sun Aug 2	RPE 6-7 (~65-70% of what you'd guess your old working weights were)	Pure re-acclimation. Leave 3-4 reps in reserve on every set. Priority is form and full range of motion, not load.
Week 2	Mon Aug 3 – Sun Aug 9	RPE 7	Small load increase from week 1 wherever form felt solid. Still 2-3 reps in reserve.
Week 3	Mon Aug 10 – Sun Aug 16	RPE 7-8	Start pushing loads on main compound lifts specifically (squat, bench, deadlift, OHP, row). Accessories can stay moderate.
Week 4	Mon Aug 17 – Sun Aug 23	RPE 8	Normal working intensity now. Add weight or reps on every lift where last week felt clean.
Week 5	Mon Aug 24 – Sun Aug 30	RPE 8-9	Push it — this is your last week before September's hypertrophy block ramps volume further.
Aug 31	Mon	Start of next block	Begin treating this like a normal week going into September.

Rule of thumb every session: if a lift felt easy at the prescribed reps last time you did it, add 2.5-5kg (or 1-2 reps) this time. If it felt like a genuine grind, repeat the same weight and try to beat reps.

The Six Sessions (exercise lists — same as your main program)

PUSH A

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Barbell Bench Press	3-4 x 6-8	2-3 min
Incline Dumbbell Press	3 x 8-10	90 sec
Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press	3 x 8-10	90 sec
Cable Lateral Raise	3 x 12-15	60 sec
Triceps Rope Pushdown	3 x 10-12	60 sec
Overhead Triceps Extension	2 x 12-15	60 sec

PULL A

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Seated Cable Row	3-4 x 8-10	2 min
Pull-ups / Lat Pulldown	3-4 x 8-10	2 min
Chest-Supported Machine Row	3 x 10-12	90 sec
Face Pull	3 x 15	60 sec
Barbell/EZ Bar Curl	3 x 10-12	60 sec
Hammer Curl	2 x 12	60 sec

LEGS A

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Barbell Back Squat	3-4 x 6-8	3 min
Romanian Deadlift	3 x 8-10	2 min
Leg Press	3 x 10-12	90 sec
Walking Lunges	2 x 12/leg	90 sec
Leg Curl	3 x 12	60 sec
Standing Calf Raise	4 x 15	45 sec

PUSH B

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Overhead Barbell Press	3-4 x 6-8	2-3 min
Flat Dumbbell Press	3 x 8-10	90 sec
Cable Fly	3 x 12-15	60 sec
Dumbbell Lateral Raise	3 x 15	60 sec
Close-Grip Bench Press	3 x 8-10	90 sec
Diamond Push-ups (or cable)	2 x AMRAP	60 sec

PULL B

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Barbell Row	3-4 x 6-8	2 min
Chin-ups (underhand)	3 x 8-10	90 sec
Single-Arm Cable Row	3 x 10/side	90 sec
Lat Pullover (cable or dumbbell)	3 x 12-15	60 sec
Rear Delt Fly	3 x 15	60 sec
Incline Dumbbell Curl	3 x 10-12	60 sec

LEGS B

Exercise	Sets x Reps	Rest
Front Squat or Hack Squat	3-4 x 8	2-3 min
Bulgarian Split Squat	3 x 10/leg	90 sec
Leg Extension	3 x 12-15	60 sec
Seated Leg Curl	3 x 12-15	60 sec
Seated Calf Raise	4 x 15	45 sec
Hanging Leg Raise (core)	3 x 12-15	60 sec

Week 1 note: on every session above, drop the top set range by one (e.g., 3-4 sets → do 3, not 4) and treat the listed rep range as a ceiling, not a target — this is your re-acclimation buffer. From Week 2 onward, use the full sets/ reps as written.

Note on dropping deadlifts: Seated Cable Row and Chest-Supported Machine Row now serve as your main back-thickness builders in place of the deadlift. Your hip-hinge/hamstring pattern is still covered by Romanian Deadlift in Legs A, so nothing's missing structurally — you're just avoiding the specific movement, not losing the muscles it trains. Revisit adding conventional deadlift back in September if you want to.

Full August Day-by-Day Calendar

Date	Day	Session
Wed Jul 29	Wed	Legs A
Thu Jul 30	Thu	Rest
Fri Jul 31	Fri	Push B
Sat Aug 1	Sat	Pull B
Sun Aug 2	Sun	Rest
Mon Aug 3	Mon	Push A
Tue Aug 4	Tue	Pull A
Wed Aug 5	Wed	Legs A
Thu Aug 6	Thu	Rest
Fri Aug 7	Fri	Legs B
Sat Aug 8	Sat	Push B
Sun Aug 9	Sun	Rest
Mon Aug 10	Mon	Push A
Tue Aug 11	Tue	Pull A
Wed Aug 12	Wed	Legs A
Thu Aug 13	Thu	Rest
Fri Aug 14	Fri	Push B
Sat Aug 15	Sat	Pull B
Sun Aug 16	Sun	Rest
Mon Aug 17	Mon	Push A
Tue Aug 18	Tue	Pull A
Wed Aug 19	Wed	Legs A

Date	Day	Session
Thu Aug 20	Thu	Rest
Fri Aug 21	Fri	Legs B
Sat Aug 22	Sat	Push B
Sun Aug 23	Sun	Rest
Mon Aug 24	Mon	Push A
Tue Aug 25	Tue	Pull A
Wed Aug 26	Wed	Legs A
Thu Aug 27	Thu	Rest
Fri Aug 28	Fri	Push B
Sat Aug 29	Sat	Pull B
Sun Aug 30	Sun	Rest
Mon Aug 31	Mon	Push A (rolls into September's block)

Pattern logic: Push A / Pull A / Legs A run every Mon/Tue/Wed without exception — those are your anchor sessions. Fri/Sat alternate between Push B+Pull B one week and Legs B+Push B the next, so Legs get trained roughly every 5th day on average across the month instead of stacking two leg sessions close together in the same week.

Logging (do this from day 1)

Use a notes app or a lifting app (Strong, Hevy — free tiers are enough). For every working set, log weight x reps. This is what actually lets you tell whether you're progressing or just repeating the same numbers — don't skip it, even in week 1.

If You Miss a Day

Don't try to "make it up" by doubling a session. Just pick back up on the next scheduled day. Missing one session out of 20+ in a month changes nothing meaningful; stressing about it and overcompensating is what actually derails a program.